must have got a tool (and so the people) to create enough democratic pressure on the governments of the time regarding fiscal prudence.

ZERO-BASE BUDGETING

The idea of zero-base budgeting (ZBB) first came to the privately owned organisation of the USA by the 1960s. This basically belonged to a long list of guidelines for managerial excellence and success, others being Management by Objectives (MBO), matrix Management, portfolio Management, etc to name a few.[51] It was the US financial expert ***Peter Phyrr*** who first proposed this idea for government budgeting and Jimmy Carter, Govornor of Georgia, USA was the first elected[52] executive to introduce ZBB to the public sector. When he presented the US Budget in 1979 *as the US President* it was the first use of the ZBB for any nation state. Since then many governments of the world have gone for such budgeting.

Zero-base budgeting is the allocation of resources to agencies based on periodic re-evaluation by those agencies of the need for all the programmes for which they are responsible, justifying the continuance or termination of each programme in the agency budget proposal—in other words, an agency reassesses what it is doing from top to bottom from a hypothetical ***zero base.***[53]

There are three essential principles of the ZBB. Some experts say it in a different way there are three essential questions which must be answered objectively before going for any expenditure as per the techniques of ZBB:

(i) Should we spend?

(ii) How much should we spend?

(iii) Where should we spend?

There are *three* special features of this budgeting which distinguishes it from the traditional budgeting. These features, in brief, are as under:

(i) The conventional aggregate approach is not applied in it, in which each department of the government prepares their own budget for many activities in the aggegate and composite form, making it